



Amazon drone army

Amazon to begin delivering parcels using drones later this year in California
<https://digit.in/jul22-17>



Meta Boutique

Meta to launch online store to push digital avatar clothing sales
<https://digit.in/jul22-18>

way around. One of the biggest developments in the effort to make robots more humanised came recently, when researchers were able to grow living human skin around a robotic finger. The aim here was to make robots more human-like in terms of their physical appearance. According to the researchers who were involved in this development, "... these findings show the potential of a paradigm shift from traditional robotics to the new scheme of biohybrid robotics that leverage the advantages of both living materials and artificial materials." There is still a lot of testing to be done though, to ensure that these skin cells can survive outside research conditions.

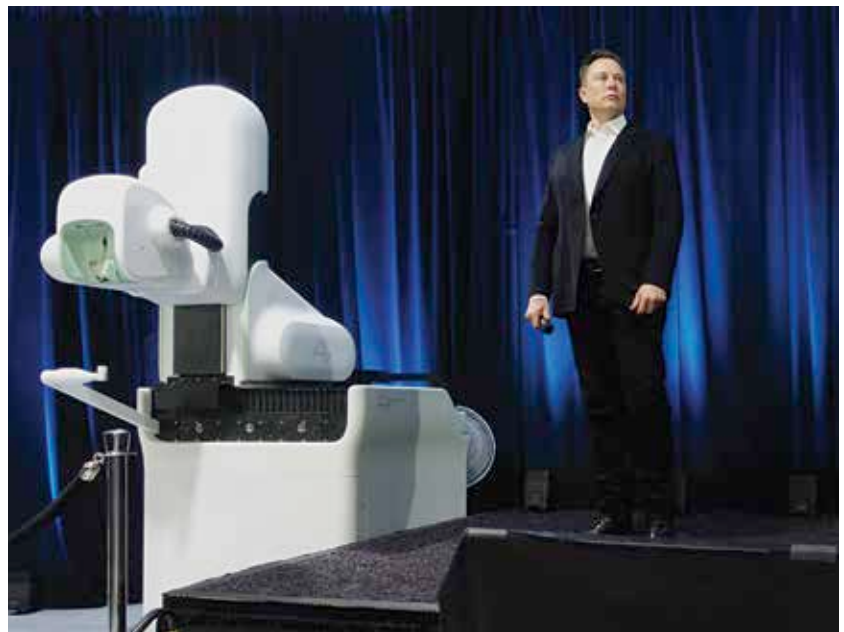
Additionally, researchers have been able to successfully grow muscles around mechanical robotic joints. While the muscles were relatively weak at the time of their development, recent findings have pointed towards stronger ones not being that far from being a reality. Now, the only thing that remains is the stuff that would help robots make better use of their physical form. With the developments taking place in terms of artificial intelli-



Looks pretty real to me!

gence, things look promising. After all, AI could be the cognitive foundation of the 'more human' robots.

Recently, claims were made that Google's AI has become sentient. There is nothing to comment on here, as the claim could not have been further from the truth. However, this might be achievable someday. The best brains of the planet are at it. We can see the implications of the developments taking place in AI research and development in our daily lives too. Smartphone assistants are more pow-



Leader of the cyborg world

erful than ever, and in New York, the state department has already started a scheme to distribute robot assistants to the elderly.

This is where the simultaneous cross-development of humans and robots comes in. With progress happening at both ends, it would be a great guide for researchers in this field to ensure that they don't accidentally create something that would be, in gamer terms, overpowered!

MUSKY DREAMS

Apart from all the scholarly brains who are at it in terms of developing tech that would enable a cyborg future, there's one man who never fails to grab headlines with his escapades. You might have already guessed it. Elon Musk, a pioneer in developing and funding research surrounding cutting-edge technology, co-founded Neuralink in 2016. Since then, the company has been developing tech that looks like it could be sitting either on or in our heads in coming years.

Their journey has been marred by some controversies seeping in here and there. Nevertheless, progress points in the right direction. Musk does not miss an opportunity

to comment on the developments either. Recently, when asked whether Neuralink can cure tinnitus, he said in a Tweet, "Definitely. Might be less than 5 years away, as current version Neuralinks are semi-generalized neural read/write devices with ~1000 electrodes and tinnitus probably needs <<1000. Future gen Neuralinks will increase electrode count by many orders of magnitude." This, for anyone, seems to be a good enough development that would help bring cyborg tech into mainstream while also working towards a greater good.

All of this put together indicates that progress is happening. There's no shortage of funds or resources being allocated to its development.

Smartphones have given us a stronger information and communication network. Easy access to knowledge or just the simple power of hyper-fast communication, is indication enough that a cyborg future is right at our doorsteps. Until then...

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